

PMGM7017

Negotiation and Conflict Management

Class A: Mondays, Wednesdays, Thursdays 2.00pm – 5.00pm (3/F, Admiralty Town Centre)

Professor

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Course Description

The objective of this course is to provide students with the relevant knowledge and practice opportunities to become more effective negotiators. Students will learn about conceptual frameworks and principles from various disciplines – communication, social psychology, and decision-making – to ask better questions, come up with creative options, and to optimize their outcomes. Students will also apply what they learned in simulated role-playing exercises where they negotiate with each other.

The course is structured in a way that students learn the most when they actively engage with class materials. Students are expected to participate in class discussions to better integrate concepts, practice their communication skills, and cultivate on-the-spot critical thinking skills. They are also expected to reflect on their performance to identify opportunities for improvement in subsequent negotiation simulations.

Programme Learning Outcomes

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline

PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge

PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership

PLO4: Developing global outlook

PLO5: Mastering communication skills

Course Learning Outcomes

CLO1: Demonstrate understanding of the core negotiation frameworks

CLO2: Apply fundamental negotiation concepts to negotiations in the real world

CLO3: Engage in critical self-assessment of strengths, and areas for growth in negotiation skills

CLO4: Develop critical thinking skills to adapt to various negotiation contexts

Grading Policies

1	Attendance	10%
2	Participation	20%
3	Individual Self-Reflection	30%
4	Final Negotiation Paper	40%
Final		100%

Course Grade Descriptors

Final Grade	Tentative Range	Grade Descriptors
A+,A,A-	100-90%	Student has consistently demonstrated an excellent grasp of negotiation concepts as evidenced by original or exceptionally astute analysis and application of learned concepts
B+,B,B-	89-80%	Student has demonstrated a substantial grasp of negotiation concepts, as evidenced by above average performance in analysis and application of learned concepts
C+,C,C-	79-70%	Student has demonstrated a fair grasp of negotiation concepts, as evidenced by average performance in analysis and application of learned concepts
D+,D,D-	69-60%	Student has demonstrated limited grasp of negotiation concepts, as evidenced by barely satisfactory performance in analysis and application of learned concepts
F	< 60%	Student has demonstrated very limited grasp of negotiation concepts, as evidenced by poor performance in analysis and application of learned concepts

a. Attendance (10%)

This course is built around role-playing exercises between you and your assigned partners. Your attendance is crucial for the success of these experiential-learning activities. In line with school policy, an attendance rate of 70% is required for all MGM courses. Each unexcused absence will lead to a penalty of 1% of your final grade but 3 or more unexcused absences will result in a failing grade. Attendance is counted from the first class, including the add/drop period, no matter when you are enrolled in the course.

b. Participation (20%)

Your participation grade will be assessed in several ways. First, you will assess your own participation using a short Discussion Contribution Report due at the end of each class session. The Discussion Contribution Report will ask you to rate yourself using a 0-2 scale (refer to the section on Critical Thinking to understand what counts as a significant contribution to class discussion).

Self-Rating	Description
0	No contribution to class discussion
1	Minimal contribution to class discussion
2	Significant contribution to class discussion

The ratings will be summed at the end of the semester and will be scaled to make up 10%. This is based on an honor system. I will review your self-ratings and reserve the right to make changes (upward or downward) to your ratings.

The *other 10% of the grade* relies on the submission of 5 planning documents. These documents help you prepare for the exercises and are due the night before class.

c. Individual Self-Reflection (30%)

This assignment is meant to help you reflect on your own performance and to devise an action plan to improve your negotiation skills.

This self-reflection should be no more than 2 pages in length. You are required to use APA format, Times New Roman size 12 font, single space and one-inch margin. Late submissions will be denied.

d. Final Negotiation Paper (40%)

To conclude the semester, you will analyze a recent real-world negotiation that you have partaken in. Any type of negotiation would be acceptable. Your grade will depend on the depth of analyses (i.e., explaining why the negotiation proceeded in a certain direction). Low scores will be given to papers focusing purely on describing what happened during the negotiation without analyzing the why, when, and how.

The paper should be no more than 9 pages in length (excluding appendices and references). You are required to use APA format, Times New Roman size 12 font, double-spaced and one-inch margin. This paper should be written in complete sentences. Late submissions will be denied.

Technology Policies

Technology devices are permitted during class unless otherwise stated by the instructor. However, personal communication devices are not allowed during class. They must be muted or turned off during class time unless given permission. Respect your fellow course-takers.

I believe that familiarizing yourself with the latest technological skills is the best way to move forward. You are permitted to use Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) to aid you in your learning journey. However, you will have to declare that you have used GenAI in your assignment. Furthermore, you will be responsible for verifying the output from GenAI. You will also need to learn how to demonstrate your contributions above and beyond what GenAI offers. This means that I have higher expectations of the quality of the work you produce.

In-Class Policies

The best way to learn is to participate actively in class because you learn how to process information quickly and learn how to ask good questions. Everyone in your class is intelligent and has unique perspectives to share. You will get more when you ask questions and express your thoughts respectfully in class. To contribute significantly to class discussions, you ought to demonstrate your critical thinking skill. I believe that this should be the most important skill you should take away from this course.

Critical Thinking

To develop your critical thinking skill, you want to pay attention to two categories of thought – 1) basic understanding and 2) deep understanding. Having a basic understanding often means that you are focused on asking or answering “where,” “who,” “what” types of questions having deep understanding means that you are focused on asking or answering “when,” “why,” and “how” types of questions. For example, saying that business management is important (what) for students (who) to study in Hong Kong (where) is different from explaining that studying business management can help students develop leadership skills (why), so that they can better motivate employees (how) when they start to lead team members (when). Demonstrating critical thinking means focusing on developing deep understanding (i.e., asking when, why, and how). To aid you in developing this skill, the class slides will explicitly use the following labels to classify the content for you. Your task will be to challenge yourself to ask “when,” “why,” and “how” types of questions in class in response to the new concepts you learn.



Key Dates to Remember

Oct 13 (Mon)	First Class
Oct 20 (Mon), 10am	End of Add/Drop Period
Nov 2 (Sun)	Individual Self-Reflection due on <u>Sunday 11:59pm (midnight)</u>
Nov 20 (Thu)	Last Class (Final Paper Consultation)
Nov 28 (Fri)	Final Negotiation Paper due on <u>Friday 11:59pm (midnight)</u>

Tentative COURSE SCHEDULE

Course References:

Brett, J. M. (2007). *Negotiating Globally: How to Negotiate Deals, Resolve Disputes, and Make Decisions across Cultural Boundaries* (2nd ed.). Jossey-Bass.

<https://www.jstor.org/stable/3270665?origin=crossref>

Fisher, R., Ury, W. L., & Patton, B. (2011). *Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In* (2nd ed.). Penguin Random House.

Thompson, L. L. (2015). *The Mind and Heart of the Negotiator* (6th ed.). Pearson.

Class	Date	Topic	Assignments
1	Oct 13 (Mon)	Course Overview & Introduction	None
2	Oct 20 (Mon)	Single-Issue Negotiations	Submit Planning Document for Biopharm & Seltex Negotiation by <u>Oct 19, 11:59pm</u>
3	Oct 22 (Wed)	Persuasion & Influence Tactics	None
4	Oct 27 (Mon)	Multi-Issues Negotiations	Submit Planning Document for Les Florets Negotiation by <u>Oct 26, 11:59pm</u>
5	Oct 30 (Thu)	Advanced Negotiation Strategies & Tactics	Submit Individual Self-Reflection Assignment by <u>Nov 2, 11:59pm</u>
6	Nov 3 (Mon)	Deception & Ethics	None
7	Nov 5 (Wed)	Team & Group Negotiations	Submit Planning Document for Cartoon Negotiation by <u>Nov 5, 11:59pm</u>
8	Nov 12 (Wed)	Agents & Representatives	Submit Planning Document for Bullard House Negotiation by <u>Nov 12, 11:59pm</u>
9	Nov 17 (Mon)	Disputes	Submit Planning Document for Viking Negotiation by <u>Nov 17, 11:59pm</u>
10	Nov 20 (Thu)	Final Paper Consultation (Optional)	Outline for Final Negotiation Paper